World War II

World War II commenced in September 1939 when Adolf Hitler became the Chancellor of Germany and launched an invasion into Poland. Britain ordered Germany to leave the territory they had invaded but Germany refused. In retaliation, France and Britain declared war on Germany but did not launch any military campaigns immediately. In the following year, Germany attacked Norway, Denmark, France, the Netherlands and Belgium. Because Germany had strategically planned its attacks, all of these countries fell to Germany.

German Invasion of Poland

The Nazi-Soviet Non-Aggression Pact was signed on August 23, 1939. It allowed Hitler to pursue his ambitions in the east without fear of Russian interference. Hitler had already planned to destroy Poland and to subjugate its people. The attack on Poland began at 4.45 am on Friday, September 1st, 1939. The Germans, not intending to be bogged down again in a war of trenches and stalemate, swept aside all resistance in a lightning war of blitzkrieg. The used technological military advances, coordinated attacks and abrasive speed to gain victory where possible. The German forces engaged in brutality, executions and merciless aggression against the civilian population.

Neville Chamberlain became Britain's Conservative prime minister in 1937. He signed an agreement with Poland guaranteeing assistance if they were attacked. When Hitler invaded Poland, Britain was forced to declare war on Germany on September 3rd. Six hours later, the French also declared war on Germany. Initially, the British only sent out planes carrying leaflets that were dropped among the German population. The leaflets urged the German population to stand up against Hitler so the war could be ended there and then.

On September 17th, the German war machine advanced towards Warsaw. The Soviet Union had secretly agreed to aid Germany by signing the Non-Aggression Pact and thus attacked Poland from the east. Crushed between two totalitarian heavyweights, Poland crumbled within a short period of